Maine (:)

9M 2026 Gambling Market & Regulatory Brief · Published 23 Oct 2026 (GCU casino revenue files "as of 20 Oct 2026"; sports wagering files week-ending 30 Sep 2026) · Currency USD (tables in $ millions unless stated)

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B2Tech · via Merlin

THE ONE-LINE VERDICT

Maine is a small, two-casino, tribal-exclusive-mobile market growing low-single-digits: 9M 2026 land-based GGR was $129.4m (+2.3%), carried entirely by slots (+4.5%) while tables fell 10%, and sports handle rose 10% to $450.2m with September hold normalising to 10.4%. The state keeps ~42% of casino GGR and 10% of sports AGR, and the only route to the online casino upside is through the Wabanaki Nations — whose iGaming bill (LD 1164) remains the single swing factor for the next 12-24 months.

9M-26 CASINO GGR (2 CASINOS)	9M-26 SLOT GGR	9M-26 TABLE GGR	9M-26 STATE TAKE (CASINO)	9M-26 SPORTS HANDLE	SEP-26 SPORTS AGR
$129.4m	$112.4m	$17.0m	$54.5m	$450.2m	$6.3m
+2.3% YoY	+4.5% YoY	-10.1% YoY	+3.6% YoY; 42.1% of GGR	+10% YoY (secondary)	+36.5% YoY; hold 10.4%

1 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- **Headline: land-based GGR +2.3% to $129.4m in 9M 2026.** Gambling Control Unit (GCU) files for Hollywood Casino Bangor and Oxford Casino sum to $129,397,375 vs $126,445,679 in 9M 2025 — reconciling exactly to the Gaming Intelligence lead. Q3 accelerated to +4.8% ($47.0m) after a flat H1 (+1.0%, $82.4m); September was +7.5% ($15.4m).
- **Product mix: slots carry the market, tables shrink.** Slot GGR $112.4m (+4.5%) was 86.9% of casino GGR; table GGR $17.0m (-10.1%). Oxford tables fell 18.3% (drop -8.1%, hold 20.8% vs 23.4%); Hollywood tables +0.7% on drop +12.2% but hold compressed to 21.9% from 24.4%.
- **Operator split: Oxford (Churchill Downs) 59.2% / Hollywood (PENN) 40.8%.** Oxford 9M GGR $76.6m (flat, -0.03%); Hollywood $52.8m (+6.0%), the growth engine on slot volume (funds-in +15.4%) with 621 machines vs Oxford's ~946.
- **Market size incl. sports: ~$178m in 9M 2026 (estimate).** Casino $129.4m (primary) plus sports AGR of ~$48.6m (derived from reported 9M tax of 'nearly $4.9m'; secondary). FY2025 was $234.6m per AGA: casino $166.4m (71%) + sports $68.2m (29%), the GCU casino figure matching AGA to within $0.1m.
- **Online penetration ~27% — and it is sports-only.** Maine has no legal iGaming; mobile sports wagering (>99% of sports AGR per AGA) is the whole regulated online channel. Treat 'online share' as ~27% of total 9M GGR (estimate).
- **Sports wagering 9M 2026: handle $450.2m (+10%), September AGR $6.34m (+36.5%).** September handle slipped 3.4% to $61.05m but hold rose to 10.4% from ~7.4%; DraftKings took $50.8m (83% share) at 10.7% hold. Four reporting groups file with the GCU: two mobile (DraftKings via Penobscot/Maliseet/Mi'kmaq; Caesars via Passamaquoddy) and two retail (Oxford Sportsbook; First Tracks Investments/Oddfellahs).
- **Regulator and law.** The GCU sits within the Department of Public Safety, under a Gambling Control Board; casinos operate under Title 8 MRSA ch. 31 (slots/table games), sports wagering under ch. 35 (live since Nov 2023). Figures are 'subject to audit'. Lottery is run separately by BABLO and is excluded here (n/a).
- **Casino tax base is GGR, and it is heavy: ~42% effective.** Hollywood: 1% of gross slot machine income (coin-in) + 39% of net slot income + 16% of net table income (effective 41.6% of GGR in 9M). Oxford: 46% of net slot income + 16% of net table income (effective 42.5%). 9M 2026 take $54.5m (+3.6%), Q3 $19.9m (+6.4%); FY2025 $69.3m.
- **Sports tax is light: 10% of adjusted gross sports wagering receipts (AGR).** GCU page verified: 1% GCU admin, 1% Gambling Addiction Prevention & Treatment Fund, 0.55% harness racing, 0.55% Sire Stakes, 0.4% Agricultural Fair Promotion, 6.5% General Fund. September take $634k; 9M ~$4.9m. Plus 0.25% federal excise on handle.
- **Combined state take 9M 2026 ≈ $59.4m** (casino $54.5m primary + sports ~$4.9m secondary). AGA puts FY2025 total gaming tax at $75.9m (+4.3%); GCU casino $69.3m + 10% of $68.2m sports = $76.2m, a $0.3m gap likely from base definitions.
- **Licensing is closed in practice.** Two casino licences exist; statutory caps (3,000 slots statewide / 1,500 per facility; 100-mile siting restriction [not re-verified today]) and the referendum history mean a third property needs legislation. Mobile sports licences are reserved to the four Wabanaki Nations (one each; two skins live); retail facility licences are open to casinos, commercial tracks and OTBs. Mobile licence fee $200,000 per 4-year term [per Title 8 §1205; not re-verified today].
- **Operator landscape: DraftKings dominates sports (~83% of September handle); Caesars is the distant #2.** PENN has no retail or ESPN Bet presence in Maine because mobile is tribal-exclusive; Oxford launched a retail book in 2025. The Portland Oddfellas retail book was denied a permanent licence in Jan 2025 (AGA), yet First Tracks Investments (Oddfellahs) still files 2026 revenue with the GCU — status detail [unverified].
- **Payments reality is US-standard, not mobile-money.** ACH/online banking, debit and wallet rails via the DraftKings/Caesars platforms; the sports framework restricts credit-card funding of accounts [not re-verified today]. Casinos are cash/TITO-based with ~$1.1bn of 9M funds-in across the two floors.
- **Responsible gambling and advertising are among the stricter US regimes.** Minimum age 21 for casino and sports; a GCU-administered statewide self-exclusion list; a dedicated Gambling Addiction Prevention and Treatment Fund funded from both verticals; Chapter 41 sports rules restrict college-campus advertising, under-21 imagery and 'risk-free' promotional language [rule detail not re-verified today].
- **Direction of travel: tribal iGaming is the swing factor.** LD 1164 (Wabanaki-exclusive internet gaming) passed both chambers in 2025 but faced gubernatorial opposition and was carried over; its 2026 outcome could not be verified in this research [unverified]. Governor Mills is term-limited and Maine votes on 3 Nov 2026 — the next administration decides whether online casino arrives and who controls it.
- **Hold normalisation is the near-term earnings lever in sports.** 9M hold ~10.8% (AGR ~$48.6m / handle $450.2m, estimate) vs AGA-implied

2025 levels; Q4 NFL volume will set FY2026 sports AGR, which we estimate at $70-75m (+3-10%).

- **Read-through for B2Tech: a B2B/partner market, not a licence market.** There is no direct route to a mobile licence (tribal exclusivity), the two casinos are vertically owned by PENN and Churchill Downs, and retail sports is sub-1% of AGR. Realistic entries are (i) platform/content supply to the tribes' current or future partners, (ii) positioning for a tribal iGaming skin if LD 1164 or a successor passes, or (iii) ETG/cabinet supply to Oxford, which began reporting electronic table game win in June 2026.

2 MARKET SUMMARY

US $M (GGR UNLESS STATED)	9M-26	9M-25	YOY	Q3-26	Q3 YOY	FY-25
LAND-BASED CASINO GGR (2 CASINOS) — PRIMARY GCU						
Total casino GGR	**129.40**	**126.45**	**+2.3%**	**46.97**	**+4.8%**	**166.36**
Slots (net slot income)	112.44	107.58	+4.5%	41.21	+7.4%	141.87
Table games (net table income)	16.96	18.87	-10.1%	5.77	-10.8%	24.50
Oxford Casino (Churchill Downs)	76.57	76.59	-0.0%	28.53	+4.7%	100.27
Hollywood Casino Bangor (PENN)	52.83	49.85	+6.0%	18.44	+4.9%	66.10
SPORTS WAGERING — SECONDARY READS OF GCU FILES						
Sports handle	450.2	~409 (implied)	+10%	n/a	n/a	n/a
Sports AGR (adjusted gross receipts) 9M AGR derived from reported 9M tax of ~$4.9m at 10%; Covers tracker shows $48.6m. Treat as estimate.	~48.6 (est.)	n/a	n/a	Sep: 6.34	Sep: +36.5%	68.2 (AGA)
Total market GGR (casino + sports)	**~178.0 (est.)**	**n/a**	**n/a**	**n/a**	**n/a**	**234.6 (AGA)**
Online (mobile sports) share of total GGR	~27% (est.)	n/a				29%
TAX						
Casino tax base / rate	GGR: HW 1% coin-in + 39% slot + 16% table; OX 46% slot + 16% table					
Casino state take	54.53	52.63	+3.6%	19.91	+6.4%	69.34
Effective casino take / GGR	42.1%	41.6%		42.4%		41.7%
Sports tax base / rate	10% of AGR (+0.25% federal excise on handle)					
Sports state take	~4.9	n/a	n/a	Sep: 0.63	+36.5%	~6.8 (implied)
LICENSING						
Casino licences / slot machines in play / tables	2 / 1,567 / 35	2 / ~1,570 / 36				2
Mobile sports licences (tribal) live / available	2 skins (4 nations) / 4					
Retail sports facilities reporting	2 (Oxford Sportsbook; First Tracks/Oddfellahs)					
Mobile sports licence fee	$200,000 / 4 yrs [not re-verified]					
Casino licence fees	n/a [not verified]					

3 DEEP-DIVE — LAND-BASED CASINOS (SLOTS & TABLE GAMES)

Slots +4.5% carry a +2.3% market; tables -10% with hold compression at both properties; Hollywood outgrows Oxford.

AGGREGATE GGR

9M 2026 GGR of $129.40m (+2.3%): slots +4.5% to $112.44m carry the market while tables fell 10.1% to $16.96m.

- H1 essentially flat at +1.0% to $82.4m; January -3.4% and May -0.6% offset February's +9.1%.
- Q3 did all the work: +4.8% to $47.0m (July +3.5%, August +3.6%, September +7.5%).
- First 20 days of October added a further $9.2m.
- All figures gross of tax and before promotional allowances, which Maine does not net from the tax base.

HOLLYWOOD CASINO BANGOR

Hollywood (PENN) grew 6.0% to $52.83m, but strong volume gains were largely given back in hold compression on both slots and tables.

- Slots $44.68m (+7.0%) on funds-in $393m (+15.4%) across 621 machines (up from ~611); hold on funds-in eased to 11.4% from 12.3%.
- GCU-reported win on coin-in 8.43% (payback 91.57%); implied coin-in from the 1% gross-slot-income line ~$528m for 9M.
- Tables $8.15m (+0.7%) on drop $37.2m (+12.2%); hold fell to 21.9% from 24.4%.
- Win per unit per day ~$264 for slots and ~$2,300 per table (13 tables).

OXFORD CASINO

Oxford (Churchill Downs) was flat at $76.57m (-0.03%) as 3.0% slot growth was offset by an 18.3% table decline.

- Slots $67.76m (+3.0%) on funds-in $706m (+8.4%) across ~946 machines (down from 959); win on coin-in 7.50% (payback 92.50%).
- Tables $8.81m (-18.3%) on drop $42.3m (-8.1%); hold 20.8% vs 23.4%.
- Slot win per unit per day ~$262, identical to Bangor despite a looser floor; table win ~$1,470 per table per day across 22 tables.
- New 'ETG win/loss' line from June 2026 ($0.20m through September; $0.25m through 20 Oct) signals response to table weakness with electronic table games.

MARKET STRUCTURE

Oxford's share of casino GGR slipped to 59.2% from 60.6%; supply caps are not binding, so catchment and New England competition set the ceiling.

- Both properties far below the statutory 1,500-machine per-facility cap and 3,000 statewide cap [caps per Title 8 §1020; not re-verified today].
- Ceiling set by southern-Maine/New Hampshire border catchment and competition from Massachusetts' Encore and MGM Springfield, New Hampshire charitable casinos and historical horse racing venues.
- Full-year 2025 GGR $166.36m (Hollywood $66.10m, Oxford $100.27m), reconciling with AGA's $141.9m EGD + $24.5m tables.

OPERATOR RELEVANCE

The land-based segment is closed to operators; commercial relevance is only as a supplier into a ~1,570-machine, 35-table estate.

- Two licences, both vertically owned by listed US groups, with no licensing window.
- 100-mile siting rule [not re-verified today] effectively requires legislation for a third property; tribal casino bills have surfaced repeatedly.
- Supplier opportunity in cabinets, ETGs and systems; state takes ~42% of GGR, capping operator appetite for aggressive capex and promotions.

US $M — GCU REVENUE DISTRIBUTION FILES	9M-26	9M-25	YOY	Q3-26	Q3 YOY	SEP-26	SEP YOY
HOLLYWOOD CASINO BANGOR							
Net slot income	44.68	41.76	+7.0%	15.61	+5.4%	4.96	+6.6%
Net table income	8.15	8.09	+0.7%	2.83	+2.5%	0.98	+11.1%
Total GGR	**52.83**	**49.85**	**+6.0%**	**18.44**	**+4.9%**	**5.93**	**+7.3%**
Slot funds-in / machines / win% (coin-in)	393.1 / 621 / 8.43%	340.6 / ~611 / 8.4%	+15.4%				
Table drop / hold	37.23 / 21.9%	33.17 / 24.4%	+12.2%				
OXFORD CASINO							
Net slot income	67.76	65.81	+3.0%	25.60	+8.7%	8.29	+9.5%
Net table income (incl. ETG from Jun-26)	8.81	10.78	-18.3%	2.94	-20.8%	1.20	-4.3%
Total GGR	**76.57**	**76.59**	**-0.0%**	**28.53**	**+4.7%**	**9.49**	**+7.5%**
Slot funds-in / machines / win% (coin-in)	706.4 / ~946 / 7.50%	651.9 / 959 / 7.7%	+8.4%				
Table drop / hold	42.27 / 20.8%	45.98 / 23.4%	-8.1%				
STATEWIDE							
Total casino GGR	**129.40**	**126.45**	**+2.3%**	**46.97**	**+4.8%**	**15.42**	**+7.5%**
Monthly 2026 GGR Jan–Sep Trade press (CDC Gaming) reported April as -0.9%; current GCU files show +2.3% — the 2025 base appears to have been restated. GCU figures used.	12.61 / 12.72 / 14.20 / 14.16 / 14.90 / 13.84 / 15.56 / 16.00 / 15.42		-3.4 / +9.1 / -1.3 / +2.3 / -0.6 / +1.1 / +3.5 / +3.6 / +7.5%				

4 DEEP-DIVE — SPORTS WAGERING (TRIBAL MOBILE + RETAIL)

Handle +10% to $450.2m in 9M; September AGR +36.5% on hold normalising to 10.4%; DraftKings ~83% share; retail immaterial.

HANDLE AND AGR

9M 2026 handle rose 10% to $450.2m; September AGR jumped 36.5% YoY to $6.34m as hold normalised.

- Market live since 3 Nov 2023 under Title 8 ch. 35; four GCU files: three nations (DraftKings), Passamaquoddy (Caesars), Oxford Sportsbook retail, First Tracks Investments (Oddfellahs) retail.
- 9M handle $450.2m (+10% YoY, implying ~$409m in 9M 2025); September handle $61.05m (-3.4% YoY, +23.8% MoM with the NFL).
- September AGR $6.34m (+36.5% YoY, +62.1% MoM); September tax $634,222.
- Primary GCU PDFs could not be parsed, so sports figures are tagged secondary; Covers tracker shows $444.5m handle / $48.6m AGR / 11.0% hold; GCU-sourced $450.2m used.

HOLD AND SHARE

Hold is the story: September hold of 10.4% versus ~7.4% a year earlier, with DraftKings holding ~83% of handle.

- DraftKings' hold rose to 10.7% from 7.2%, lifting AGR 42% to $5.4m on a 3.4% smaller handle of $50.8m.
- Caesars holds roughly 16% share; two retail books well under 1% combined; AGA says mobile accounted for >99% of 2025 sports revenue ($68.2m, +20.1%).
- Reported 9M tax of 'nearly $4.9m' at 10% implies 9M AGR ~$48.6m and 9M hold ~10.8% (estimate).

LICENSEE ECONOMICS

Sports licensees pay 10% of AGR plus 0.25% federal excise versus ~42% of GGR for casinos, driving lobbying on both sides.

- No promotional deduction [deduction treatment not re-verified today].
- Asymmetry plus tribal mobile exclusivity explains casinos lobbying for their own mobile access.
- Tribes are now pressing to extend exclusivity into iGaming.

RETAIL

Retail is structurally marginal with handle under 1% of the state total; there is no commercial case for standalone retail entry.

- Oxford opened its book in 2025; Hollywood Bangor has no reporting sportsbook (PENN's ESPN Bet has no Maine route).
- Portland Oddfellas permanent licence denied by the Gambling Control Board in January 2025, briefly pausing retail betting; First Tracks continues to file 2026 revenue — licensing basis [unverified].
- Facility licences remain available to commercial tracks and OTBs.

OUTLOOK AND ENTRY

FY2026 AGR could land around $70-75m (estimate, +3-10%); mobile entry is only as a tribe's platform partner and no uncontracted skin exists.

- Assumes Q4 handle grows mid-single digits on the 2025 base and hold stays near 10% through the NFL/NBA run-in.
- Two of four nations' skins contracted to DraftKings, one to Caesars; Mi'kmaq/Maliseet rights bundled into the DraftKings arrangement.

US $M — SECONDARY READS OF GCU SPORTS WAGERING FILES	SEP-26	SEP-25	YOY	AUG-26	MOM	9M-26	9M YOY
Statewide handle	**61.05**	**~63.2**	**-3.4%**	**~49.3**	**+23.8%**	**450.2**	**+10%**
Statewide AGR	**6.34**	**~4.64**	**+36.5%**	**~3.91**	**+62.1%**	**~48.6 (est.)**	**n/a**
Hold (AGR/handle)	10.4%	~7.4%		~7.9%		~10.8% (est.)	
State tax @10% AGR	0.634	0.465	+36.5%			~4.9	n/a
DraftKings (Penobscot/Maliseet/Mi'kmaq) handle / share	50.83 / 83%	52.6 / n/a	-3.4%			n/a	
DraftKings AGR / hold	5.4 / 10.7%	3.8 / 7.2%	+42.2%			n/a	
Caesars (Passamaquoddy) handle (implied)	~10 (est.)	n/a				n/a	
Retail (Oxford Sportsbook; First Tracks/Oddfellahs)	<1% of handle					<1%	
FY-25 sports AGR (AGA)						68.2	+20.1%

5 DEEP-DIVE — LICENSING, TAX & REVENUE DISTRIBUTION

Closed casino duopoly taxed at ~42% of GGR; tribal-exclusive mobile taxed at 10% of AGR; statutory earmarks route proceeds to education, racing and agriculture.

REGULATORY FRAMEWORK

GCU licenses and audits all gambling; casino supply is statutorily capped so a third venue requires legislation.

- Gambling Control Unit (Department of Public Safety) covers casinos, sports wagering, fantasy, harness racing/OTB and charitable gaming; five-member Gambling Control Board adjudicates licences.
- Casinos under Title 8 MRSA ch. 31 by referendum (Bangor 2003; Oxford 2010); table games added 2012.
- Caps of 3,000 slots statewide and 1,500 per facility plus 100-mile siting restriction [not re-verified today]; Wabanaki casino bills filed repeatedly without passage.

CASINO TAX STRUCTURE

Casino taxation on GGR is among the heaviest in the US, with Hollywood paying 1% of coin-in plus 39% of net slot income and Oxford 46%.

- Hollywood: 1% of gross slot income ($5.28m in 9M 2026, implying ~$528m coin-in) to General Fund, plus 39% of net slot income across twelve earmarks (10% Healthy Maine, 10% harness purses, 4% racing, 3% GCU, 3% fairs, 3% Sire Stakes, 2% UMaine, 1% each MCCS, OTB, Bangor, plus Maine Maritime).
- Oxford: 46% of net slot income (25% K-12, 4% UMaine, 4% Penobscot and Passamaquoddy Tribes, 3% MCCS, 3% GCU, 2% Oxford, 1% each fairs, purses, Sire Stakes, county, 0.5% each dairy and milk pool).
- Both pay 16% of net table income (Bangor: 9% General Fund, 3% GCU, 2% Veterans, 2% Bangor; Oxford: 10% K-12, 3% GCU, 2% town, 1% county).

STATE TAKE

9M 2026 state take was $54.53m (+3.6%), roughly 42% of GGR at both properties.

- Hollywood $21.95m (41.6% of its GGR); Oxford $32.58m (42.5%).
- FY2025 take $69.34m on $166.36m GGR (41.7%).
- Hollywood's 1% line on coin-in means effective burden rises when hold falls — a small but real volatility an operator should model.

SPORTS WAGERING TAX

Sports wagering is taxed at 10% of adjusted gross receipts, with mobile licences reserved to the four Wabanaki Nations.

- Distribution: 1% GCU, 1% Gambling Addiction Prevention and Treatment Fund, 0.55% Harness Racing Commission, 0.55% Sire Stakes, 0.4% Agricultural Fair Promotion, 6.5% General Fund.
- Mobile licences one per nation at $200,000 per four-year term [Title 8 §1205; not re-verified today]; facility licences open to casinos, tracks and OTBs; suppliers need own licences.
- A 16% rate was floated in 2025 budget deliberations but GCU page still states 10% [legislative outcome unverified].

COMMERCIAL READING

Fiscal design favours tribes (10% mobile sports) and earmarked beneficiaries (42% casinos); any iGaming statute will be negotiated inside this frame.

- Expect a tribal-exclusive model with a rate pitched between the two; 2025 LD 1164 debate centred on a mid-teens rate [unverified].
- Expect a parallel push from the casinos for compensation or their own skins.

TAX & LICENSING PARAMETERS (RATES ON GGR/AGR; $ WHERE STATED)	HOLLYWOOD BANGOR	OXFORD CASINO	MOBILE SPORTS (TRIBAL)	RETAIL SPORTS
Enabling law	Title 8 ch. 31	Title 8 ch. 31	Title 8 ch. 35 (2022; live Nov-23)	Title 8 ch. 35
Tax base	Net slot income + 1% of coin-in; net table income	Net slot income; net table income	Adjusted gross receipts (AGR)	AGR
Statutory rate	39% slots (+1% coin-in) / 16% tables	46% slots / 16% tables	10%	10%
Effective take / GGR, 9M-26	41.6%	42.5%	10%	10%
9M-26 state take ($m)	21.95	32.58	~4.9 (incl. retail)	immaterial
FY-25 state take ($m)	27.4 (est. from files)	41.9 (est. from files)	~6.8 (implied from AGA AGR)	immaterial
Licence holder / operator	PENN Entertainment	Churchill Downs Inc.	Penobscot+Maliseet+Mi'kmaq → DraftKings; Passamaquoddy → Caesars	Oxford Casino; First Tracks Investments (Oddfellahs)
Licence fee	n/a [not verified]	n/a [not verified]	$200,000 / 4 yrs [not re-verified]	n/a [not verified]
Supply caps	1,500 machines/facility; 3,000 statewide [not re-verified]	same	1 skin per nation (4 max; 2 live)	casinos, tracks, OTBs eligible
Federal excise	—	—	0.25% of handle	0.25% of handle

6 DEEP-DIVE — ONLINE CASINO (IGAMING) & POLITICAL DIRECTION OF TRAVEL

No legal iGaming; tribal-exclusive LD 1164 is the only live pathway and its fate turns on the 3 Nov 2026 gubernatorial election.

CURRENT STATUS

Maine has no legal iGaming; mobile sports is the only digital channel and iGaming legalisation is the only material step-change available.

- No online casino, no online lottery sales reported here (n/a), no commercial online poker.
- Mobile sports is >99% of 2025 sports AGR (AGA) and ~27% of 9M 2026 total GGR (estimate).
- Casino GGR has grown 2-3% a year.

LD 1164

LD 1164 would extend tribal mobile sports exclusivity into online casino; it passed both chambers in 2025 but was carried over, not enacted.

- Passed on narrow margins amid gubernatorial opposition; 2026 session disposition could not be verified [unverified].
- PENN and Churchill Downs oppose a tribal-exclusive model, citing cannibalisation of a 42%-taxed land-based base.
- March 2026 trade coverage framed the two properties as facing 'competition from new online' products, read as a signal the debate remained live.

POLITICAL CALENDAR

The 3 November 2026 gubernatorial election is decisive: a sponsor-friendly administration could enable a 2027 statute and 2028 launch.

- Governor Mills, who signalled a veto, is term-limited; 133rd Legislature convenes January 2027.
- A sceptical administration leaves Maine a two-casino, sports-only state through the forecast horizon.
- Expect tax design to borrow from the 10% sports template under Appropriations Committee pressure toward the casino rate.

B2TECH STRATEGY

No direct licence exists; optionality must come via Wabanaki relationships and a supplier licence, with a modest $150-250m GGR market at maturity.

- Houlton Band of Maliseet Indians and Mi'kmaq Nation, bundled into the DraftKings sports deal, are natural candidates for a differentiated iGaming partner.
- A content/platform supplier licence would be required under any statute.
- Market size estimate benchmarked to New England per-capita comparators; not a top-tier US state.

STATUS OF ONLINE VERTICALS AND LEGISLATIVE ITEMS (AS OF 2 NOV 2026)	STATUS	WHO MAY OPERATE	TAX	NEXT CATALYST
Mobile sports wagering	Live since 3 Nov 2023	Four Wabanaki Nations (one skin each); DraftKings & Caesars contracted	10% of AGR	Q4-26 NFL hold; any rate-change bill in 133rd Legislature
Online casino / iGaming (LD 1164)	Not legal; bill carried over from 2025 — 2026 outcome [unverified]	Proposed: Wabanaki Nations exclusively	Proposed mid-teens % of GGR [unverified]	3 Nov 2026 gubernatorial election; Jan 2027 session
Online lottery / iLottery	n/a (BABLO; outside GCU scope)	Maine State Lottery	n/a	n/a
Fantasy contests	Legal; GCU-regulated (Title 8 ch. 33)	Licensed DFS operators	n/a [not verified]	—
Third / tribal land-based casino	Not authorised; repeated bills failed	Would require legislation or referendum	—	Jan 2027 session
Casino-operator mobile sports access	Not permitted (tribal exclusivity)	—	—	Likely trade-off in any iGaming deal

7 DEEP-DIVE — PAYMENTS, RESPONSIBLE GAMBLING & ADVERTISING

Conventional US rails; 21+ across casino and sports; strict GCU advertising code and a ring-fenced addiction fund — compliance cost is modest but conduct expectations are high.

PAYMENTS

Payments are mainstream US rails with credit cards restricted for sports accounts and no offshore payment-blocking regime beyond UIGEA.

- Casino floors run on cash and ticket-in/ticket-out; 9M funds-in $393m at Hollywood and $706m at Oxford.
- DraftKings and Caesars apps accept ACH/online banking, debit cards and wallets through national stacks.
- Credit card funding restricted [not re-verified today]; no mobile-money dimension.

RESPONSIBLE GAMBLING

RG is statutorily funded via 1% of sports AGR (~$0.49m in 9M 2026) and casino slot earmarks, with 21+ age limits.

- 3% GCU administration/gambling addiction earmark on slots: $1.68m Hollywood and $2.18m Oxford in 9M 2026.
- GCU runs a statewide voluntary self-exclusion programme across casinos and sportsbooks.
- Minimum age 21 for casino and sports (18 for lottery and pari-mutuel) [not re-verified today]; 211 Maine / 1-800-GAMBLER signposting mandatory in advertising.

ADVERTISING RULES

GCU's sports advertising code is among the tighter US regimes, and the Board has shown it will exercise discretion on suitability.

- No advertising on or directed at college campuses or college-aged audiences; no depiction of under-21s.
- Restrictions on 'free' or 'risk-free' language, mandatory RG messaging, operator liability for affiliates [rule text not re-verified today].
- Little enforcement controversy to date, but January 2025 denial of Portland Oddfellas permanent licence demonstrates Board discretion.

ENTRANT IMPLICATIONS

Compliance burden is light in money terms but reputationally sensitive; iGaming rules will carry stricter advertising and affordability expectations.

- Legislature is attentive to tribal equity and problem-gambling optics.
- Deposit-limit, time-limit and cooling-off tooling should be expected as table stakes in any future online casino rule set.

CONDUCT & PAYMENTS PARAMETERS	CASINO	MOBILE SPORTS	SOURCE / STATUS
Minimum age	21	21	Title 8 [not re-verified]
Self-exclusion	GCU statewide list	GCU statewide list	GCU
RG funding, 9M-26 ($m)	3.86 (3% GCU admin/addiction earmark, both casinos)	~0.49 (1% of AGR to Addiction Fund)	GCU files; sports estimate
Credit-card funding	Cash/TITO; ATM on floor	Restricted [not re-verified]	Title 8 ch. 35
Promo deduction from tax base	None	None [not re-verified]	Title 8 §1036 / ch. 35
Advertising code	General	No college-campus targeting; no under-21 imagery; 'risk-free' limits; RG messaging	GCU Ch. 41 rules [not re-verified]
Federal excise	—	0.25% of handle	IRC §4401

8 HIGHLIGHTS & LOWLIGHTS

▲ HIGHLIGHTS

- Sports hold normalisation is lifting AGR far faster than handle: September AGR +36.5% on handle -3.4%, hold 10.4% vs ~7.4%; 9M handle +10% to $450.2m. A 10% AGR tax with no promo deduction leaves ~90% of AGR with the licensee and its platform partner — the best fiscal terms in the market. mixed
- Casino volumes are healthy even if GGR is not: slot funds-in +15.4% at Hollywood and +8.4% at Oxford, with Q3 GGR +4.8% and September +7.5%. The floor is ~1,570 machines, well below the 3,000 statewide cap, so supplier upside exists without any licensing event. structural
- Oxford has started reporting ETG win (from June 2026) in response to an 18% table decline — a live procurement window for electronic table game and cabinet suppliers at the state's larger property. early
- Tribal iGaming (LD 1164) is the only legal online casino pathway in New England's least-penetrated state; two of the four Wabanaki Nations' rights are bundled into a sports-only DraftKings deal, creating a natural opening for a differentiated iGaming platform partner if the statute passes. watch
- Fiscal dependence creates allies: 9M 2026 casino take of $54.5m funds K-12 education ($19.1m from Oxford alone), harness racing, agricultural fairs and tribal payments — a broad beneficiary coalition that tends to support revenue-raising expansion in Augusta. structural
- Regulatory transparency is high: weekly-updated GCU revenue files by property and product, with distributions itemised to the cent, make diligence and partner monitoring cheap relative to most African jurisdictions B2Tech covers. structural

▼ LOWLIGHTS

- No direct licence route: casinos are a closed duopoly (PENN, Churchill Downs) with statutory supply caps and a 100-mile siting rule; mobile sports is tribal-exclusive with all four nations already contracted (DraftKings ~83%, Caesars). Entry is B2B or via a tribe only. structural
- Casino tax burden of ~42% of GGR (46% on Oxford slots; 1% of coin-in plus 39% at Bangor) compresses operator margins and promotional capacity; any iGaming regime negotiated against this benchmark risks a rate well above the 10% sports template. structural
- Table games are in structural decline: statewide -10.1% in 9M and -10.8% in Q3, with hold down ~250-350bp at both properties and Oxford drop -8.1%; the growth in the land-based market is slots-only. structural
- Scale is small and growth is low: casino GGR is on track for ~$170m in FY2026 (+2-3%) and total market ~$240-245m; even a successful iGaming launch would likely make Maine a sub-$250m online state at maturity (estimate). structural
- Political uncertainty is acute: the LD 1164 outcome could not be verified, the incumbent governor opposed tribal iGaming, and the 3 Nov 2026 election plus a new Legislature in Jan 2027 reset the agenda; sports tax-rate increases (a 16% figure circulated in 2025) remain a live fiscal temptation. governance
- Licensing discretion has teeth: the Gambling Control Board denied a permanent licence to the Portland Oddfellas sportsbook operator in Jan 2025, pausing retail betting; the basis on which First Tracks Investments (Oddfellahs) continues to report in 2026 is unverified — a reminder that suitability findings can abruptly end a retail footprint. one-off
- Data gap: sports wagering figures here rely on three corroborating trade reads of the GCU September files rather than the parsed primary PDFs; the Covers tracker shows a ~$6m lower 9M handle. Treat sports AGR and hold as estimates until reconciled. watch

9 FORECAST & OUTLOOK

Guidance bridge. Maine does not issue guidance, so the bridge below moves from AGA's FY2025 total of $234.6m (casino $166.4m + sports $68.2m) to our FY2026 estimate. Casinos: 9M GGR $129.4m plus Q4 at +3% on the Q4-25 base of $39.9m gives ~$170.5m (+2.5%), driven by Hollywood slots and Oxford's Q3 recovery, partly offset by continued table erosion. Sports: 9M AGR ~$48.6m plus a Q4 of $22-26m (NFL/NBA peak at ~10% hold on handle growing mid-single digits) gives $70-75m (+3-10%), the whole uplift coming from hold rather than volume. Combined FY2026E ~$241-246m (+3-5%), with state gaming tax of ~$78-80m (casino ~$71.5m at 42%, sports ~$7-7.5m). No iGaming revenue is included in 2026-27; it is the binary swing factor.

FY-25 TOTAL GGR (AGA)	CASINO FY-26E (9M $129.4M + Q4E ~$41M)	SPORTS AGR FY-26E (9M ~$48.6M + Q4E $22-26M)	FY-26E TOTAL MARKET GGR
$234.6m	**~$170.5m**	**~$70-75m**	**~$241-246m**
	+$4.1m / +2.5%	+$2-7m / +3-10%	+3-5% (estimate)

Independent view. Our independent view: **land-based GGR grows 2-3% a year through 2027 with mix shifting further to slots** (tables already 13% of GGR, trending to ~11%), and **sports AGR grows faster than handle as hold settles at 9.5-10.5%** versus 2025's ~7-8% months; **state take rises in line, ~$78-80m in FY2026E**. On rules: the **sports tax rate is more likely to rise than fall** over two years (fiscal pressure plus the 42% casino benchmark make 10% look anomalous to Appropriations), while **iGaming is a coin-flip dependent on the November 2026 governor** — if a supportive administration takes office, expect a tribal-exclusive statute in the 2027 session with launch in 2028 at a mid-teens-to-20% GGR rate and some compensation mechanism for the two casinos; if not, Maine stays sports-only. **Leverage/market structure direction: more concentrated, not less** — DraftKings' ~83% share is unlikely to be challenged without a third skin or iGaming cross-sell. For B2Tech the actionable path is supplier licensing and a tribal relationship now, so that optionality exists when the statute moves.

What to watch next quarter:

- 3 Nov 2026 gubernatorial result and the Jan 2027 133rd Legislature: re-filing or enactment of LD 1164 (tribal iGaming), any casino compensation/skin trade-off, and the proposed tax rate.
- Any bill to lift the sports wagering tax above 10% of AGR (a 16% figure circulated in 2025) or to change the AGR definition (promo deductibility).
- Q4 2026 GCU sports files: whether hold holds near 10% through the NFL season and whether handle growth re-accelerates after September's -3.4%.
- Oxford table/ETG trajectory: table GGR -18% in 9M; watch ETG win ramp (first reported June 2026) and any cabinet/system procurement.
- Hollywood Bangor slot momentum (funds-in +15%) and whether PENN seeks a retail book or legislative mobile access.
- Gambling Control Board licensing decisions on retail sports facilities (First Tracks Investments/Oddfellahs status) and any suitability enforcement.
- Full-year 2026 GCU files (early Jan 2027) and any audit restatements — current files are explicitly 'subject to audit'.

DATA CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM Market reports in USD; no FX conversion required. HIGH confidence on all land-based casino figures (parsed directly from GCU revenue distribution PDFs for 2025 and 2026; reconcile exactly to the $129.4m lead and to AGA's FY2025 $141.9m slots / $24.5m tables). MEDIUM on sports wagering: handle $450.2m, September AGR $6.34m, hold and DraftKings share come from three mutually consistent trade reads of the GCU September files, not the parsed primary PDFs; 9M AGR (~$48.6m) is derived from the reported ~$4.9m tax. LOW on legislative status: LD 1164 (tribal iGaming) 2026 outcome, any sports tax-rate change, licence fee amounts, slot caps/100-mile rule, credit-card restrictions and Chapter 41 advertising details are from the analyst's framework knowledge and are flagged [not re-verified today]/[unverified]. Casino licence fees and lottery figures: n/a. April 2026 casino YoY differs between GCU current files (+2.3%) and contemporaneous trade press (-0.9%); GCU used.

Sources: [Primary] Maine Gambling Control Unit — Casino Revenue Distribution (index page; Title 8 §1036 distribution note); [Primary] GCU — Hollywood Casino 2026 Monthly Revenue as of 20 Oct 2026 (PDF); [Primary] GCU — Oxford Casino 2026 Monthly Revenue as of 20 Oct 2026 (PDF); [Primary] GCU — Hollywood Casino 2025 Monthly Revenue (PDF, full year); [Primary] GCU — Oxford Casino 2025 Monthly Revenue (PDF, full year); [Primary] GCU — Sports Wagering Revenue Distribution (10% AGR distribution; licensee file index); [Secondary] American Gaming Association — State of the States 2026: Maine overview (FY2025 GGR $234.6m; tax $75.9m); [Secondary] Gaming Intelligence — Maine land-based gaming revenue nears $130 million in 9M 2026 (lead; paywalled); [Secondary] Gaming Intelligence — Maine sports handle hits $450 million in 9M 2026; [Secondary] LegalSportsBetting — Maine Sports Betting Revenue Jumps 36% in September (14 Oct 2026); [Secondary] BettingNews — Maine Sportsbook Handle Hits $450.2M Through Q3; [Secondary] Covers — Maine Betting Revenue & Handle Tracker; [Secondary] CDC Gaming — Maine casino revenue rises 3.6% to $16 million in August (and Jul/May/Apr monthly reports); [Secondary] Gambling.com — Maine Casino Revenue Climbs 9% in February (Mar 2026).

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